

Africa Fintech Foundry — Pitch Friday Application

ZeroPay | BETONIQ(WEST) Limited | July 31, 2026 Deadline

AFRICA FINTECH FOUNDRY — PITCH FRIDAY APPLICATION

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COMPANY NAME: BETONIQ(WEST) Limited PRODUCT NAME: ZeroPay STAGE: Pre-Seed / Pre-Series A
SECTOR: Fintech — Offline Payments Infrastructure HEADQUARTERS: Abuja, FCT, Nigeria FOUNDER: Tom Ugboaga (Sole Founder and Inventor)

ELEVATOR PITCH (50 words)

ZeroPay is the world's first offline-first, uncapped NFC contactless payment protocol. It enables merchants to accept digital payments with ZERO internet connectivity using patent-pending PUF + ECC cryptography. 38 million unbanked Nigerians. ₦847 billion in annual informal cash transactions. ZeroPay captures all of it — offline, secure, instant.

THE PROBLEM

1.4 billion people globally are unbanked. In Nigeria alone, 38 million people operate entirely in cash — not because they choose to, but because every existing digital payment solution fails them at the moment it matters most: when the internet goes down.

Paystack, Flutterwave, Opay, PalmPay — every Nigerian fintech relies on continuous internet connectivity to process a transaction. When the network drops — which in Abuja's informal markets happens multiple times daily — the terminal stops. The merchant reverts to cash. The transaction is invisible to the financial system.

The problem is not cultural. It is not a trust problem. It is an infrastructure problem. And it has never been solved.

Until now.

THE SOLUTION

ZeroPay is the world's first offline-first, uncapped NFC contactless payment protocol. It processes transactions of any value, with zero internet, using a four-layer patent-pending cryptographic engine:

Layer 1 — NFC Communication (ISO 14443-A/B): The customer taps their NFC device to the ZeroPay terminal. No app required. No QR code. No internet.

Layer 2 — PUF Authentication: A Physical Unclonable Function — a silicon fingerprint burned into the chip at manufacturing — authenticates the terminal device instantly. The PUF cannot be cloned. Cannot be replicated. Not even by the most advanced AI system. (See: CNN, July 22, 2026 — "OpenAI model hacks rival's servers" — software-layer attacks cannot breach hardware-level PUF identity.)

Layer 3 — ECC P-256 Signing: The transaction is cryptographically signed using Elliptic Curve Cryptography — the same standard used by central banks globally. The signature is generated entirely offline, on the terminal processor. No server required.

Layer 4 — Distance Bounding Protocol: Nanosecond-precision signal timing prevents relay attacks — the most sophisticated form of NFC fraud. ZeroPay is the only payment system in the world to implement Distance Bounding at point of sale.

The signed token is queued in the terminal's offline batch engine. When connectivity is restored — even briefly — the Batch Sync Engine transmits the verified, signed batch to the settlement rail (Paystack Nigeria, Flutterwave Ghana, Stripe UK). The settlement rail never touches the transaction at point of sale. It only receives the already-authenticated batch. ZeroPay is fully PSP-agnostic.

THE SECOND INNOVATION — SOLAR MESH HUB

In environments where connectivity is absent entirely, ZeroPay's solar-powered LoRaWAN mesh relay network creates localised payment infrastructure from the ground up. Hubs propagate signed transaction batches across 2–15km per hop until they reach connectivity. No internet installation required. No government infrastructure required. Solar-powered. Community-run.

THE MARKET

Global unbanked population: 1.4 billion Nigeria unbanked: 38 million Annual informal cash transaction value in Nigeria: ■847 billion (\$550 billion) Global payments infrastructure market: \$847 billion Addressable market — offline-capable payment terminals globally: \$120 billion by 2030

Zero direct competitors in uncapped offline NFC payment authentication. Visa and Mastercard enforce a £100/\$200 cap on offline contactless payments because they cannot authenticate high-value transactions without internet. ZeroPay removes that cap permanently.

BUSINESS MODEL

1. Hardware Terminal Sales: ZeroPay NFC terminal at ■45,000 per unit (vs. ■150,000+ for standard POS) 2. SaaS Fee: ■5,000/month per merchant terminal for platform access and settlement 3. Transaction Fee: 0.5% per settled transaction (vs. 1.5% industry standard) 4. Mesh Hub Revenue: Solar Mesh Hub installation at ■850,000 per hub — 2km radius coverage, serving 50–100 merchants 5. Cross-Border FX: ZeroPay + IMTO

partner (Flutterwave/Thunes) — FX spread sharing on international corridors

Projected Year 1 Revenue (Abuja Pilot — 200 merchants): Hardware: ■9,000,000 SaaS: ■12,000,000/year
Transaction Fees: ■8,500,000/year Total Year 1: ■29,500,000 (~\$19,000 USD)

Projected Year 3 Revenue (National — 2,000 merchants + 5 Mesh Hubs): ■295,000,000/year (~\$190,000 USD)

TRACTION

- Patent-pending invention disclosure timestamped and filed — April 2026 - Paystack Merchant Agreement signed — July 14, 2026 - Functional interactive demo platform live — March 2026 - BETONIQ(WEST) Limited CAC registered — Abuja, FCT, No. 56802 - Interledger Foundation concept note submitted - Pre-Series A target: \$4.5M USD - Investor demo suite: 4 interactive 2D animated explainers live - NotebookLM AI-generated audio explainers completed for investor pitch

THE FOUNDER

Tom Ugbodaga MSc — NFC for Contactless Technology in Financial Transactions, University of Gloucestershire, England, 2011 (Top Graduate, Best Result in Cohort) MSc — Computer Security Systems BSc Physics, Nigeria

ZeroPay is not a pivot. It is not a startup idea. It is the 15-year commercialisation of world-class academic research in NFC security. Tom is the sole inventor. The patent is his.

THE ASK — AFRICA FINTECH FOUNDRY PRIZE

We are applying for the Africa Fintech Foundry Pitch Friday prize to fund: 1. ZeroPay hardware terminal prototype (PUF chip + NFC reader): \$4,000 2. First Abuja merchant pilot (10 merchants, 3 months): \$3,500 3. CBN PSSP licence application fee: \$1,500 4. Legal and compliance (patent filing, partnership agreements): \$1,000 Total: \$10,000

This is not a speculative grant. This is the capital that puts the first ZeroPay terminal into the hands of a Games Village merchant — and proves to every investor, regulator, and partner that ZeroPay works in the real world.

Africa Fintech Foundry will be the first organisation to fund the world's first offline-first payment protocol. That matters.

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